



[U-M Employees](#)

Travel Booking

[Collegiate Travel Planners](#) (CTP), the university's designated travel partner, provides negotiated rates on airfare, hotels, rental cars, and more for university business travel. U-M and CTP discounts are automatically applied when booking business travel with CTP.

Additional benefits of booking business travel with CTP:

- Fully supported business travel

- 24/7 assistance to travelers through agents and the travel portal

- Easily apply unused tickets and e-credits to new bookings or reallocate them to alternate travelers within the university

- Book for up to 9 guests and/or employees at the same time through CTP's online booking tool, [Lightning](#) ↗

- A dedicated team of agents who specialize in [booking group travel](#) for groups of 10 or more

CTP has a team of travel agents dedicated to U-M, which is available M-F from 8 a.m. to 6 p.m. Eastern Time. A general after-hours service is available outside of business hours for emergency situations at the same main phone line.

Book through the [online travel booking tool](#) ↗ or via agent assistance. Agents can be reached by phone, email, or the [Travel Request Form](#). ↗

For training and informational materials, access the [Travel Booking TDx Knowledgebase](#) ↗.

For student travel, please review [Student Travel: Guide to Booking, Policy, and Reconciliation](#) ↗ prior to booking.

Announcements

New Mileage Reimbursement Rate – Effective August 1, 2026

Effective August 1st, 2026, the university's [mileage reimbursement](#) rate increased to 76 cents per mile from 72.5 cents per mile for qualified university business travel that commences on or after that date. For more information on mileage reimbursement, see [Expense Reporting](#).

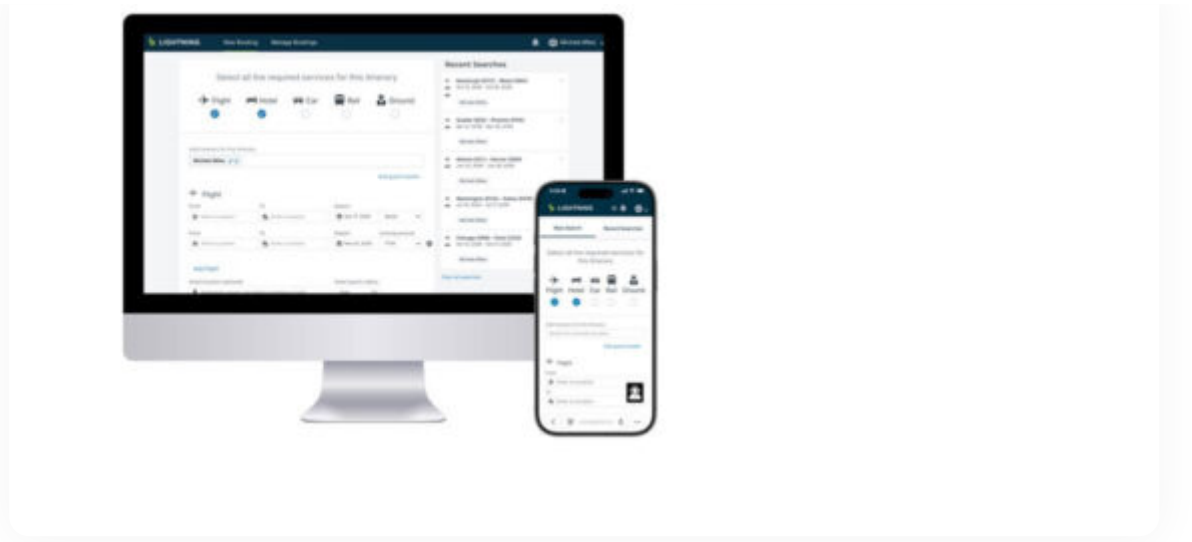
More flight-booking options available for U-M-related travel

Effective May 1, 2026, U-M employees have more options available when booking flights for university-related business. While the use of [Collegiate Travel Planners](#), U-M's designated travel partner, will still be the preferred way to book flights for university-related travel, it will no longer be required. If, however, employees elect to book flights outside of CTP, a U-M payment card ([PCard or Travel & Hosting Card](#)) must be used for payment. In addition, travelers will now be able to book basic economy fares using the CTP Lightning booking tool. [Read more in the University Record](#). [↗](#)

Lightning has a New Look!

Starting March 16, 2026, [Lightning](#) [↗](#) has a visual refresh with lighter, brighter colors designed to make the platform easier to see and use. All features and functionality remain the same.

The updated visual design is also reflected when booking with Lightning in the [CTM Mobile App](#) [↗](#).





Contact Us

Travel Booking and Support

Phone: (877) 804-3688

International: (402) 252-4404

Email: umichigan@ctp-travelservices.com

Hours: 8 a.m. to 6 p.m. (ET) Monday – Friday

For after-hours emergency assistance, please use the phone numbers provided above. No additional fees apply.

[Group Travel Support](#)

U-M Travel Policy Questions

Phone: (734) 764-8212, option 2

[SSC Travel & Expense General Inquiry eForm](#) 

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Online Booking

Group Travel

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Travel Policy

The Travel and Business Hosting Expense Policy is published in [SPG 507.10-1](#) . For a summary of allowable expenses, refer to the [Summary of Allowable and Unallowable Expenses](#) .

Reminder: Individual schools/colleges and departments may have stricter policies than those at the university level. It is highly recommended that you familiarize yourself with all departmental travel policies, as well as the SPG, before booking university travel.

Airfare

Employees are strongly encouraged to book airfare using the [university's travel partner](#). If an employee elects to book flights outside of CTP, a U-M payment card ([PCard or Travel & Hosting Card](#)) must be used for payment.

The university will pay for the cost of standard coach airfare and travelers should always select the lowest price airfare within the bounds of the most logical schedule. It is highly recommended to book airfare at least 14 days in advance to take advantage of better pricing and availability. For full U-M guidelines and limitations, please see [SPG 507.10-1](#). [↗](#)

The university has negotiated discounted rates with our four largest airline suppliers. There are also several perks available when booking using these contracts. Visit the [Delta](#), [United](#), [American](#), and [Southwest](#) supplier pages to learn more about perks, including how to upgrade to complimentary preferred seating.

Lodging

The university will reimburse lodging expenses at a reasonable standard room rate. When the hotel is at a conference or convention site, reimbursement will be limited to the conference rate, if available.

NOTE: *Most hotels require a credit card to reserve a hotel room, however, this card may not actually be charged. The traveler may be asked to present their actual form of payment upon arrival. Contact the hotel directly to put a PCard/Travel Card on file to be charged. An authorization form may be required.*

Car Rental

Employees should use the university's preferred car rental suppliers, [National Car Rental and Enterprise Rent-A-Car](#). This ensures that appropriate insurance is included and discounted university rates are applied.

Risk Management advises that travelers decline all collision insurance for vehicle rentals originating in the U.S. as the university self-insures for commercial rental vehicle loss/damage. When traveling outside the U.S. it is recommended that travelers accept collision insurance. See the [Insurance and Claims Administration website](#) [↗](#) for more information on insurance coverage.

Personal Car Mileage or Car Rental?

[Use the Trip Optimizer tool](#) [↗](#) to receive a cost estimate for claiming mileage reimbursement vs. renting a car.

International Travel

The International Travel Policy (which includes U.S. territories) is published in [SPG 601.31](#) [↗](#).

NOTE: Booking international travel through the university's designated travel partner does not automatically register your international [U-M Related Travel](#) [↗](#) in the U-M Travel Registry. You must [register your international travel](#) [↗](#) separately.

Travel Meals/Per Diem

U-M adheres to [U.S. General Services Administration \(GSA\)](#) [↗](#) per diem policy for employee travel meals and incidental expenses. The per diem rates are set by the GSA for travel to domestic/CONUS (continental U.S.) and international/OCONUS (foreign and non-continental US) destinations. Travelers are allowed 75 percent of the per diem amount on the first and last days of travel. University employees on business travel should pay

for their own individual meals and incidentals out of pocket while traveling. Per diem can be claimed via an expense report after the trip and is calculated based on the travel destination. Receipts are not required. For full U-M guidelines, please see [SPG 507.10-1](#) 

(Looking for the Hosting policy? See [Expense Reporting](#).)

Non-employee Travel

Whenever possible, business travel for non-employees (students/guests) should be paid for with a university PCard and should be arranged using the university's designated travel partner, CTP.

Non-employee travel meals are reimbursable for the actual cost incurred, provided the rate does not exceed current maximums (\$30 breakfast, \$50 lunch, \$80 dinner). In lieu of reimbursing actuals, units may also pay non-employees at a set rate, provided that the rate does not exceed the [GSA per diem rate](#) . See [Expense Reporting](#) to learn more about processing these payments.

CTM Mobile App

The [CTM Mobile app](#)  is similar to the desktop version of the CTP Lightning booking tool and will allow you to book and manage travel arrangements directly from your mobile device.

Download and learn more about the CTM Mobile App:

IOS: <https://apps.apple.com/us/app/ctm-mobile/id1396829738> 

Android: https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.travelctm.us.mobile&hl=en_AU&pli=1 

Forms

[Individual Travel Request Form \(CTP\)](#)

This form can be used to request a travel booking for an individual traveler instead of calling or emailing an agent.

[Group Booking Request Form \(CTP\)](#)

This form must be completed to start a group travel booking for a group of 10 or more travelers. Read more about the [Group Travel](#) booking process.

[Fly America Act Exception Form](#)

This form must be completed whenever non-U.S. flag air carrier service is used and intended to be charged to a federal project/grant. The completed form must be submitted with the expense report.

[Airfare Booking Exception Form](#)

This form must be completed for approval to book airfare outside of U-M policy due to extenuating circumstances.

[Request Travel-Related Disability Accommodations](#)

This form (select the “Accommodate Login” button) can be used by employees with disabilities or medical conditions to request travel accommodations, including airfare seat class upgrades, as well as exceptions to book outside of CTP Lightning, in instances where employees encounter accessibility issues using the tool. For more information, see [Airfare Booking Accessibility Guidance](#) .

More Information

[Travel Booking at U-M](#) 

[Summary of Allowable and Unallowable Travel Expenses](#) 

[Per Diem FAQ](#) 

[CTP Profile and Portal](#) 

[Travel Booking Support and Resources](#) 

Travel Resources

[U-M Benefits Office - International Travel](#)



[Global Michigan](#)



[Federal Aviation Administration \(FAA\)](#)



[US General Services Administration \(GSA\)](#)



[U-M Travel Registry](#)





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